PUBLIC POLICIES & GOVERNANCE SOCIETY · HALDIA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

Building a student organisation that could run without me

How a new campus chapter was founded, staffed, funded through local sponsorship, and handed over to a self-running team inside one academic year.

Prepared by
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Role
Co-founder · President 2026–27

Period
2025–26

Edition
Short

01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What this is

In 2025, Haldia Institute of Technology had no student body dedicated to public policy, debate, or structured public speaking. I co-founded the HIT chapter of the Public Policies and Governance Society (PPGS), a society originally run at IIT Kharagpur, and took responsibility for building and running it on the ground.

Over the following academic year I recruited the founding team, allocated roles by individual strength, ran the society single-handedly for roughly a month when contributors went quiet, negotiated sponsorship with two local businesses, delivered two competitive events, represented the college externally at IIT Kharagpur, designed a recruitment campaign after being refused classroom access, and then trained and handed the operation to the year below me.

The outcome I care most about is the last one. The society now runs a three-layer workflow across academic years and publishes without my involvement in every task. My current role is oversight, not execution.

2	2	₹10,000	~150	~40	1
Competitive events delivered end-to-end	External business partnerships secured	Direct cash sponsorship, plus one in-kind deal	Applicants to the recruitment drive	Members across academic years today	Institutional representation, IIT Kharagpur
OFFICIAL REPORT	INTERNAL RECORDS	INTERNAL RECORDS	INTERNAL RECORDS	INTERNAL RECORDS	OFFICIAL REPORT

REPORT Documented in the official PPGS Report v1.4, submitted to the institute.

INTERNAL My own records. Not independently documented. See the data note on the final page.

VISUAL Supported by event photographs, posters or published posts.

02 · THE CHALLENGE AND THE FOUNDING

A gap on campus, and permission that was not ours to assume

The gap. HIT Haldia has an active club culture: technical societies, cultural societies, an alumni club. What it did not have was a forum where students argued a position, defended it under pressure, and were judged on it. Students who wanted to build confidence in speaking and reasoning had nowhere to practise, and those preparing for UPSC or civil-services careers had no mentorship channel inside the college.

The opening. PPGS already existed and functioned at IIT Kharagpur, including UPSC mentorship. A chapter model meant we would not have to invent a curriculum, a name or credibility from scratch, but it also meant the IIT Kharagpur team had to be convinced that a Haldia chapter would not embarrass them. Subid Thakur, then in fourth year, was the main founder. I was co-founder, in third year.

> **THE ACTUAL FIRST TASK**
>
> Approval depended on persuading an external team, with no prior relationship, that two students at another institution could operate their brand responsibly. That conversation, not the paperwork, was the real first task. Permission was granted and the chapter was established.

Timeline

Mid 2025

Chapter founded and team recruited

Approach to IIT Kharagpur, permission granted, roughly 14 third-year students recruited and assigned functions by strength. INTERNAL

13 Sept 2025

Debatocracy, debate competition

First event. Faculty judges, three winners, ₹9 registration fee, in-kind food sponsorship. REPORT VISUAL

Late 2025

Contribution collapse and recovery

Contributors went quiet under academic load; I ran operations directly for roughly a month, then trained replacements. INTERNAL

21–22 Mar 2026

Sansad 2K26, IIT Kharagpur

Selected via Unstop; sole representative of PPGS and HIT off campus. REPORT VISUAL

29 Mar 2026

Voice of Ideas, extempore competition

Second event. ₹19 registration fee, ₹10,000 cash sponsorship. REPORT VISUAL

2026 · 2026–27

Recruitment drive, handover, committee formalised

Instagram-led recruitment after classroom access was refused; interviews conducted; operations delegated to the year below. Twelve-member core committee constituted, with me as President. INTERNAL REPORT

03 · TEAM BUILDING AND OPERATIONS

Recruiting into a society with no track record, then keeping it alive

The objection I had to answer

Every capable student I wanted was already in another club. Joining PPGS meant a second set of meetings and deadlines with no visible reward. I did not answer that with enthusiasm. I answered it with what the role would actually give them: **ownership** of a function rather than membership of a crowd, **access** to the IIT Kharagpur team and their mentors that no other club at HIT offered, and **a first mover's record** of something built rather than joined.

Channels used: personal network, one-to-one conversations, word of mouth, classroom promotion where permitted, and a promotional video. Roughly 14 third-year students joined. Subid recruited several fourth-year students so the chapter had senior names attached, but they were in the middle of placements, so execution fell to me as the senior-most available operator.

Roles allocated by strength, not by rank

Chapter lead and execution owner
Deepansh Deep · co-founder

EXTERNAL & INSTITUTIONAL

Deepansh Deep
IIT KGP liaison, faculty, permissions

Anand Kumar
Local business, alumni, guests

OPERATIONS & EVENTS

Deepak Raj
Event execution

Shivam Kumar
Permissions, turnout

Avinash Kumar
Coordination

MEDIA & CONTENT

Dhruv Raj
Media coordination

Amrita Kumari
Design

Alysha · Adnan Khan
Video, content

Vishal Kumar
Research

FINANCE & CONTINUITY

Anwesha Kumari
Fees, funds, spend

Anshu Raj
Cover for any function

Each person was mapped to a function they were already good at, so the first thing they did was something they could already do well. Titles above correspond to the 2026–27 core committee recorded in the official report. Roughly fourteen were recruited, two were later removed, and the committee lists twelve.

When the team stopped

The chapter ran cleanly for about a month. Then academic pressure hit the third-year batch and most contributors went quiet at roughly the same time. Nobody resigned; the work simply stopped arriving. A new organisation that goes silent in its first term does not usually recover, because there is no habit or reputation holding it up. I took the work over directly and ran the society largely on my own for approximately a month.

> **THE DECISION THAT MATTERED**
>
> Carrying the work myself kept the society alive but made it entirely dependent on one person. I treated that as a temporary fix with a deadline, not a solution. The permanent fix was to pick specific juniors, teach them each task directly, and let them own it while I checked the output.

Two removals

Shanu was a founding member and a friend who stopped contributing and stopped responding to work. Removing him had a personal cost I could not avoid. I did it anyway: a position occupied by someone not doing the work is worse than a vacancy, because it blocks a replacement and signals that the standard is optional. I raised it with the team rather than acting unilaterally, and they supported the decision. **Vishal Mandal**, admitted on a personal recommendation, showed little interest in the work and wanted the title more than the responsibility; he was removed as well. That second one was a lesson about intake rather than exit, and it is why later recruitment ran through structured interviews instead of referrals.

04 · EVENTS DELIVERED

Two competitions, run end-to-end

Promotion, paid registration, judging, execution and prize distribution, both published.

Debatocracy · 13 September 2025

~100 students reached in promotion — INTERNAL

~25 registrations at ₹9 — INTERNAL POSTER

13 competed on the day — INTERNAL · see data note, final page

Topics released 25 minutes before each round, positions and opponents assigned randomly, 15-minute rounds of argument and rebuttal, winners advancing to a final three. Two faculty judges, three winners declared. REPORT **The problem on the day:** registration did not convert. The options were to postpone, to cancel, or to run a competition visibly smaller than advertised.

DECISION

We ran it. A cancelled first event would have told the campus that PPGS could not deliver, and would have cost us two faculty judges who had given up their time. A small event that actually happened produced photographs, a published record, three winners and a faculty relationship. A cancelled event would have produced nothing.

Mine: coordination on the day, promotion, the faculty approach for judging, the sponsorship conversation, and the decision to proceed at reduced turnout. **The team's:** junior members ran classroom operations and participant management, batchmates handled logistics, the media group produced all collateral.

Voice of Ideas · 29 March 2026

Debatocracy's failure point was the gap between promotion and attendance, so the objective for the second event was explicitly to widen the top of the funnel rather than hope for better conversion. We promoted inside hostels, obtained faculty permission for classroom pitches, and approached students directly instead of relying on posters and Instagram.

~200 students reached in promotion — INTERNAL

~60 registrations at ₹19 — INTERNAL

~40 participants on the day — INTERNAL · see data note, final page

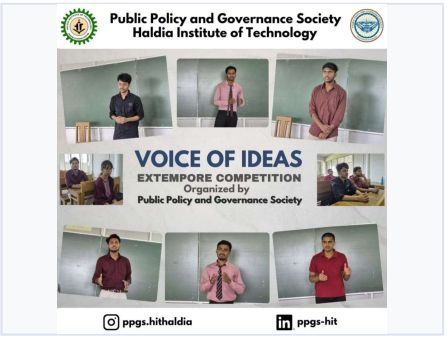
Topics announced on the spot with one minute of preparation, delivered in English, no devices, assessed on clarity, confidence, content, language and presentation. No faculty judges were available, so rather than postpone I judged alongside two third-year members. An internal panel is less credible than a faculty panel, and a future edition should book judges before registration opens.



Debatocracy, 13 September 2025. The society's first public event, three months after the chapter was approved. VISUAL



Prize distribution by the faculty judges. Faculty participation was secured for the first ever event.



Voice of Ideas participants delivering extempore speeches, 29 March 2026. VISUAL

RECOGNITION IS NOT FOLLOWER COUNT

Instagram following did not grow meaningfully across this period. Recognition inside the college did: students associated PPGS with debate and speaking events, and faculty began to know me through PPGS specifically. Social media metrics are not presented as evidence of impact anywhere in this document.

05 · SPONSORSHIP AND LOCAL PARTNERSHIPS

Two deals, structured as exchanges rather than requests

Both events were externally funded. Neither was funded by asking for a donation.

A new society has no budget and no track record, which makes the usual pitch of "please support our event" worth very little. The approach I used instead was to work out what the business wanted, work out what a student event could actually deliver against that, and propose the exchange. I handled the outreach in person, with two junior members.

PARTNERSHIP 1

Debatocracy

PARTNER

A newly opened local food business

WHAT THEY GAVE

In-kind: food packets, approximately matched to the number of people being catered for at the event

WHAT WE GAVE

Discount coupons distributed to eligible participants, approximately 20% off the customer's bill, valid for roughly one week

WHAT THEY WERE BUYING

Trial and awareness. The outlet was new and needed first-time customers and local visibility

PARTNERSHIP 2

Voice of Ideas

PARTNER

A local coffee shop

WHAT THEY GAVE

₹10,000 in direct cash sponsorship

WHAT WE GAVE

A dedicated promotional reel produced by our media team, plus coupon distribution to participants (two coffees ordered, one complimentary mini snack)

WHAT THEY WERE BUYING

Access to a student audience, produced social content they did not have to make, and a mechanism to convert attendees into footfall

Structure detail: the Debatocracy discount was proportional to spend, so a redeeming group had to place a real order to benefit, and short validity concentrated the traffic. For Voice of Ideas, ~60 coupons were prepared against registrations, ~40 were distributed to attendees and ~20 went unused.

How the conversation was actually run

01	02	03	04	05	06
Establish what we were	**Define the audience**	**Name their objective**	**State what we deliver**	**Propose the exchange**	**Deliver what was promised**
The event, the date, the format.	Who is in the room, and why that matters to a shop near campus.	A new outlet needs trial; an established one needs repeat footfall.	Coupons into a captive audience, produced content, branded association.	Specific ask, specific deliverable, no open-ended request.	Reel produced, coupons printed and handed out on the day.

What this is evidence of

Cold outreach to a business with no prior relationship; identifying the other party's commercial objective before pitching; designing an offer against that objective instead of a generic sponsorship tier; negotiating an in-kind deal when cash was not available and a cash deal when it was; and delivering the promised promotion afterwards. In commercial terms this is early-stage partnership and business development work, at small scale.

LIMITS

Outcomes were not measured for either partner: no redemption rate, no customer-acquisition count, no revenue figure. What is known is that both deals were structured around a stated commercial objective and both were delivered as agreed. Neither sponsorship appears in the official PPGS report. INTERNAL

06 · EXTERNAL REPRESENTATION AND RECRUITMENT

Representing the institution, then recruiting its next generation

Sansad 2K26, IIT Kharagpur · 21–22 March 2026

I applied through Unstop and cleared the first selection round. I asked members of the society to apply with me; they were committed to their own projects and did not. I went alone and represented the college on my own. REPORT

Assigned the role of Yogi Adityanath in the simulated parliament, I took on coordination for the bloc I was placed in: I created and administered the WhatsApp group used to coordinate it, sequenced who would speak and on what before the session rather than during it, and handled planning across both days. Nobody appointed me to that; I picked it up because the coordination was not happening otherwise.

The organisers' schedule then broke down. Components were cut, including Zero Hour, and prepared speaking opportunities did not materialise for everyone. I adjusted the bloc's sequencing to the reduced schedule and used the slot I did get.

This was participation in a simulation, not a policy role. What it evidences: competitive selection, self-directed coordination of a team of strangers, public speaking to an unfamiliar audience, and adapting when the agenda changed. It also produced the working relationship with the IIT Kharagpur PPGS leadership that the HIT chapter depends on, and the Sansad-at-HIT proposal recorded in the official report.



Speaking at Sansad 2K26, IIT Kharagpur. VISUAL



Certificate presented to faculty on return. The representation was formally recorded by the institute. REPORT

Recruitment after the main channel closed

Entering my fourth year meant the founding cohort would graduate within a year. Unless the incoming batch was recruited and trained first, PPGS would end with us, and the intake had to happen on a fixed deadline. Our most reliable channel, classroom promotion, was not approved this time.

Rather than treating the refusal as a blocker, we moved recruitment to the channel students actually use: a collaborative Instagram reel featuring six members, published as a collab so it surfaced across all six accounts rather than one.

~5,000 organic views on the recruitment reel — No paid promotion INTERNAL

~150 interview registrations — INTERNAL

Selected intake across two year groups — Structured interviews INTERNAL

I planned and ran the interview process with a friend and members of the year below. Interviews were conducted rather than positions handed out, a direct response to having previously admitted a member on a referral who did not contribute. The target was first-year students, but some second-year applicants were strong enough to select as well, which created a middle layer immediately rather than a one-year gap.

> **THE POINT OF THIS**
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> The interesting part is not the view count. It is that a channel we depended on was withdrawn on a deadline, and the response was to switch channels rather than escalate or wait. The replacement produced roughly 150 applicants for a society less than a year old.

07 · SYSTEMISATION, OUTCOMES AND CAPABILITIES

Removing myself from the critical path

A society that only works when the founder is in the room has not been built. It has been performed. The progression below was deliberate, took about a year, and is the reason PPGS still publishes when I am unavailable. Most people who run something can point at what happened while they were there. The result I am putting forward is what kept happening after I stepped back.

STAGE 1	STAGE 2	STAGE 3	STAGE 4	STAGE 5	STAGE 6
I did the work	**I picked who could take it**	**I taught the task**	**They executed**	**I reviewed**	**The gate became optional**
Direct execution when contribution collapsed.	Selected on demonstrated reliability, not eagerness.	Walked each person through the actual work.	Ownership transferred. I stopped producing.	My role narrowed to a gate, not a workstation.	Third years verify and publish without me.

Second year: implementation	Produces the content or executes the task
Third year: review and management	Checks the work, manages the batch below, escalates only what needs it
Final verification: me, when available	If I am unavailable, third years verify and publish without me

What I personally demonstrated

CAPABILITY	THE SPECIFIC THING BEHIND IT
Building from zero	Chapter founded with no members, budget, precedent or faculty relationship; all of it assembled within one academic year, and two competitions delivered end-to-end from promotion through paid registration, judging and prize distribution.
Persuasion	Convinced already-committed students to take on a second set of responsibilities for an organisation with no track record, by offering ownership and access rather than membership.
Partnership & sponsorship	Two deals closed with local businesses through in-person cold outreach: one in-kind and one ₹10,000 cash, each structured around the partner's stated commercial objective.
Stakeholder management	Sole liaison with an external institution's leadership, college faculty for judging and permissions, and local business owners.
Team design	Eleven members mapped to functions on demonstrated strength; a deputy deliberately positioned to cover my absence.
Performance management	Two members removed for non-contribution, one a personal friend and founding member, with the decision taken openly rather than unilaterally.
Operating under failure	Society carried single-handedly for roughly a month when contribution collapsed, instead of allowing it to go dormant. Ran Debatocracy at half the expected turnout rather than cancelling, and judged Voice of Ideas internally when no faculty panel was available.
Delegation & process	Successors taught the tasks directly, then given ownership; three-layer workflow built across academic years with a review gate that was progressively removed.
Succession planning	Recruited and trained two junior layers before the founding batch's final year, converting a single-batch society into a multi-year structure. When classroom recruitment was refused, switched to a collaborative Instagram reel that produced roughly 150 applicants.

Where it stands, and what is planned

Now. A twelve-member core committee for 2026–27 and roughly 40 members across academic years. Day-to-day production and review sit with the third- and second-year layers. I am President, operating in oversight: final verification when available, senior permissions, faculty and IIT Kharagpur meetings, and decisions on major events.

Planned, not delivered. Three initiatives are recorded in the official report and have not yet happened: **Drishtikon**, a policy debate scheduled for 23 August 2026; **Turn Your Court**, an extempore format arguing both sides of one policy; and **Vision to Service**, an invited-speaker session on governance careers. A campus **Sansad** is proposed following the IIT Kharagpur representation.

DATA NOTE

Figures tagged INTERNAL come from my own records and are not independently documented. Two participation figures are disputed between my records and the official report: **Voice of Ideas**, where the report records 10–15 participants and my records give ~60 registrations and ~40 participants; and **Debatocracy**, where the report records 30+ participants and my records give ~25 registrations with 13 competing on the day, presented here as 13 debaters within a room of roughly 30. Coupon redemption, customer acquisition and commercial return for both sponsors were not tracked and are not claimed. Promotion reach figures are estimates. The full 16-page edition sets out every figure with its source and confidence level.